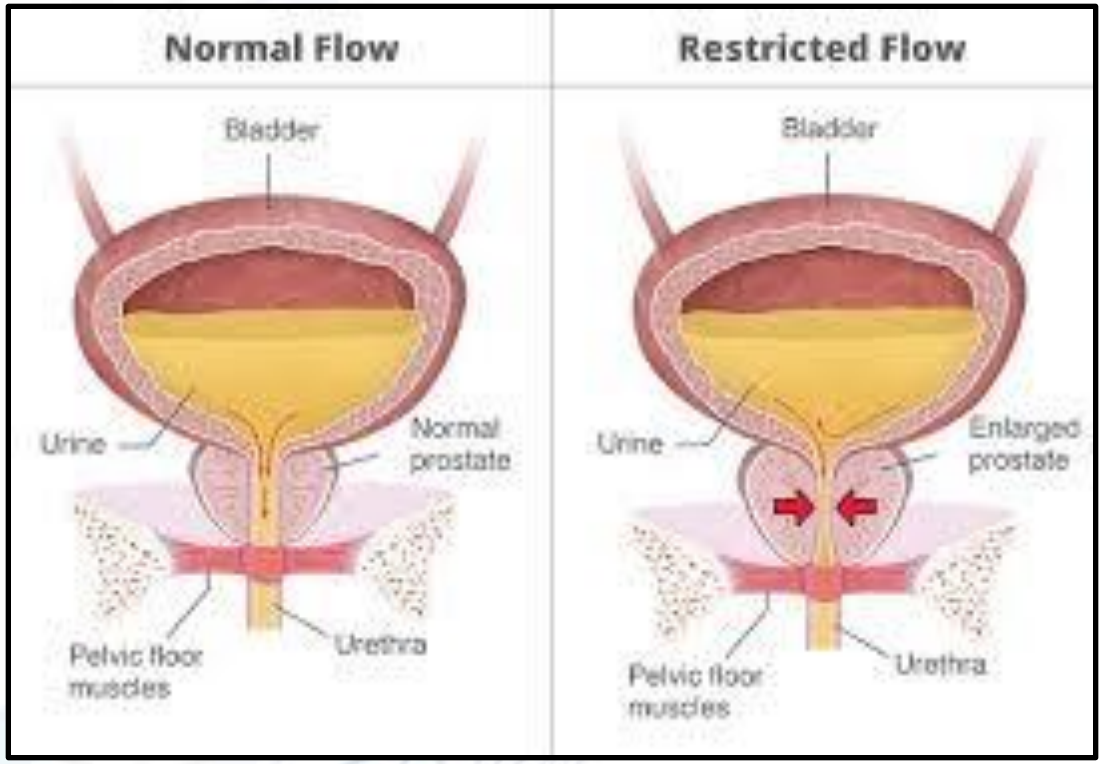
Applied anatomy

Urinary Retention:

In adult males, urinary retention is commonly caused by obstruction to the urethra by a benign or malignant enlargement of the prostate. Urinary retention in females is usually caused by inflammation around the urethra. This can cause the bladder to become greatly distended and may be drained by introducing a catheter.

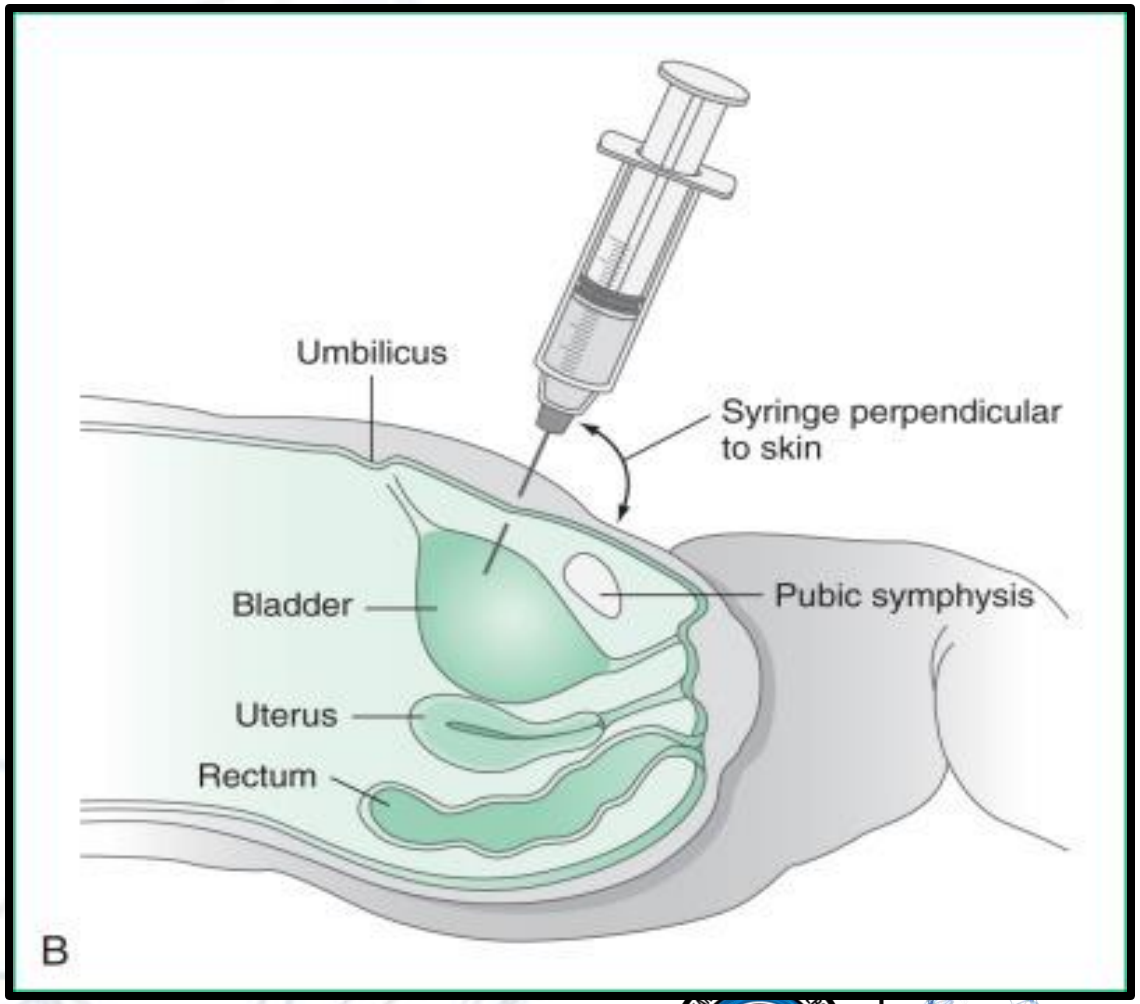


ANU MEDICAL SCHOOL PROGRAM

Applied anatomy

Suprapubic Aspiration:

As the bladder fills, the superior wall rises into the abdomen. If catheterization failed, it is possible to pass a needle into the bladder through the anterior abdominal wall above the symphysis pubis, without entering the peritoneal cavity.

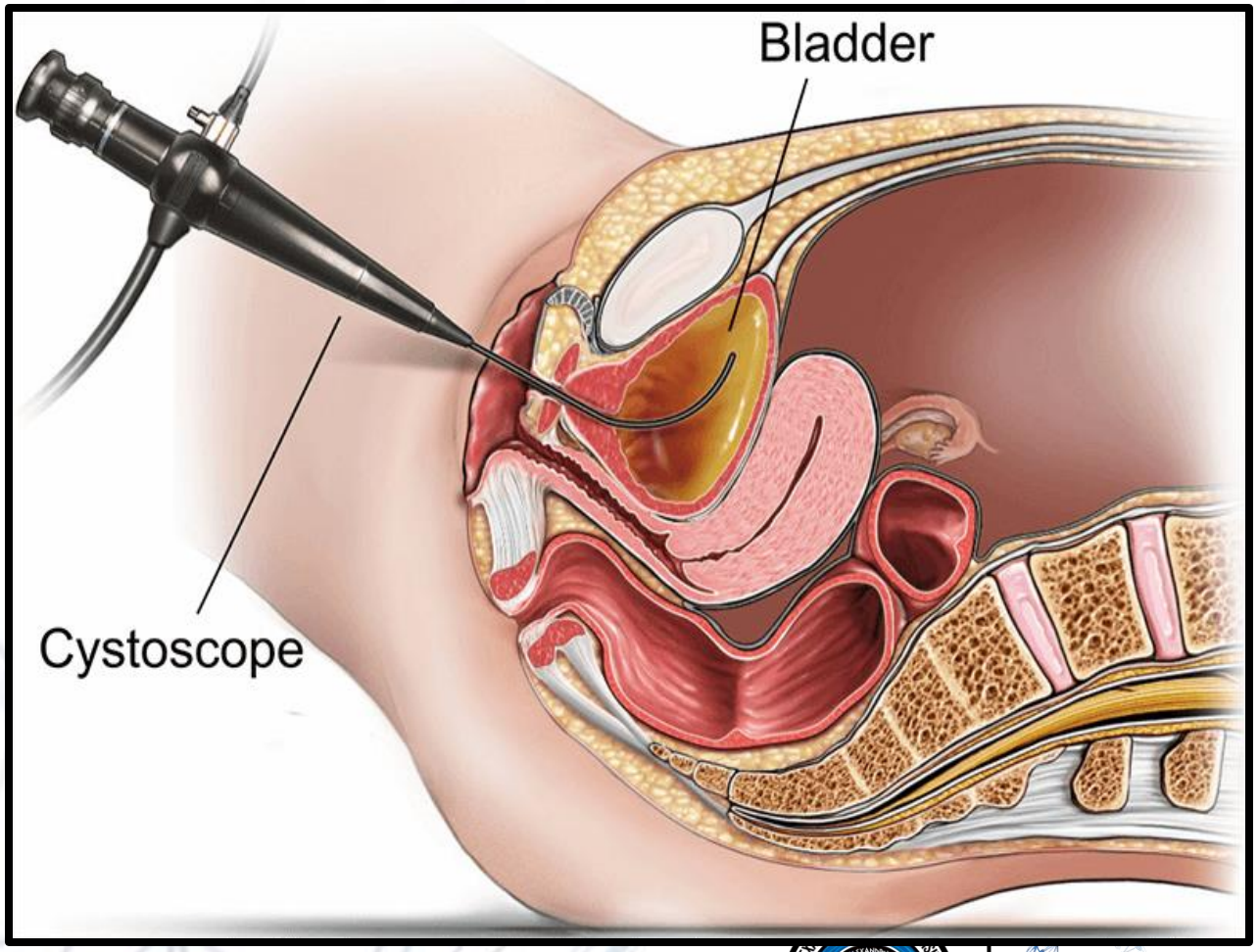


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Applied anatomy

Cystoscopy:

The mucous membrane of the bladder, the two ureteric orifices, and the urethral meatus can easily be examined by a cystoscope. With the bladder distended with fluid, an illuminated tube fitted with lenses is introduced into the bladder through the urethra.



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